

SECURITY WATCH

Microsoft isn't patching critical Skype flaw soon

A critical flaw discovered in Microsoft's popular communication app Skype could allow hackers to gain full control of host machine by granting system level privileges to a local, unauthorised user. The worst part is that Microsoft isn't set to fix this flaw any time soon, as the nature of the flaw requires a significant rewrite of the entire software code to fix it – which means that Skype users will have to wait for an entirely new version for this flaw to be taken care of.

The vulnerability itself resides in Skype's updating tool, that allows DLL hijacking. According to the security researchers who discovered it, a potential attacker could exploit the "functionality of the Windows DLL loader where the process loading the DLL searches for the DLL to be loaded first in the same directory in which the process binary resides and then in other directories."

<http://dgit.in/MSSkype>

MOBILE WATCH

Cat S61

Caterpillar is not only well established in the construction machinery business, but also the smartphone business with its 'S' range of rugged phones. They've announced an upgrade to the lineup with the Cat S61, which is being touted as a 'bigger, better, bolder' S60. The thermal imaging that the phone was well known for has been upgraded to a better resolution, so it can now read upto 400°C and live stream the same as well!

On top of that, the phone comes with an indoor air quality sensor to alert you to high levels of indoor air pollutants (VOCs) as well as laser assisted distance measurement. Additionally, the phone sports its usual ruggedness with drop proofing up to 1.8m, waterproofing up to 3m for 60 minutes, including salt water, and resilience to all types of dust.

<http://dgit.in/CatS61>



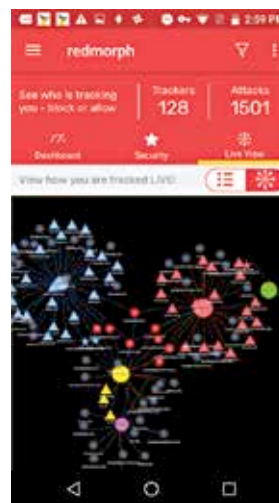
APP WATCH

Redmorph



Due to the vast technical and use case differences between a desktop and a smartphone, applying the same methods of protection on both isn't exactly effective. Redmorph has been designed from the ground up to deal with smartphone security and threats that wouldn't be as relevant to, say, a Windows user.

Once installed, the app executes an initial scan of your system that evaluates the level of risk that your phone is in due to all the apps installed on it. Post that, you are prompted to enable an app sentry and a VPN that checks your phone constantly for trackers that are sharing your information. The app will also suggest a list of apps that can be blocked from accessing the inter-



net without hampering their functionality.

Going into the live view, the app shows a list of trackers currently running on your system and the servers they connect to. Switching to the Spider-web view gives you an impressive connected graph that shows you all the trackers and how they are connected in a visual manner in real time. Redmorph is a must have for security nuts.

Ridlr



Putting IoT tech to use, Ridlr has already changed the way commuters in Mumbai use bus and metro services.

The app features smooth ticketing and pass renewal facilities for both and has the potential to change how the entire country gets its ticketing done.

Litsy



If you're a bookworm and always wanted your own social media dedicated just to the glories of literature,

Litsy is the answer. Apart from offering an Instagram-esque feed for book related posts, you can also keep track of reading lists and go through recommendations.

Thrive



Right now, Thrive is a capable app to help you with your smartphone addiction. In Thrive mode,

you won't receive any messages or calls from anyone but your favorites/VIPs and the app will send a custom auto reply to those who try to contact you.